

HP OfficeJet 4110 All-in-One

Compact and fast, but falls short

If you take a sudden look at the 4110, it may pass off for a regular office fax machine. It's much smaller than the PSC 1210, and has some extremely nifty features. This baby weighs the least amongst all the contenders.

The power and USB cables, and the driver CDs, come packaged. So do the print cartridges. There's an LCD display and nine control buttons. With the USB 2.0 feature, data transfer is fast.

The 4110 has the scan-to-mail client feature, and the Auto Document Feeder feature allows for faster copying of multiple sheets. But because of the sheet-feeder approach, one cannot scan a magazine without tearing out the page. Printouts fall over the input tray, so it's difficult to refill paper during printing.

The printing tests gave us a surprise—the OfficeJet 4110 turned out to be the fastest in both tests. The image quality tests were pretty okay, but not exactly up to the mark. It comfortably scanned our test document at 600 dpi in 112 seconds, making it the second fastest in this category. The copying tests were a different story altogether—the 4110 took way too long (38 seconds).

The HP OfficeJet 4110 All-in-one comes for Rs 8,999, which, going by the test results, is steep; the price-per-page for black and white pages comes to Rs 3.03, and Rs 5.17 for colour. Overall it loses out on all the tests, and is a bad choice.



HP OfficeJet 4110 All-in-One

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 8,999
Pros: Very fast printing speed
Cons: Lacks a flatbed scanner

Lexmark X1150

The cheapest alternative to your printer

The design of the X1150 is both sleek and intuitive. The device is large, however, and very tightly packed—the headroom between the scanner bed and the printer interior is small, making it cumbersome to replace cartridges. Also, the X1150 does not have an LCD panel, or standalone copying functions—it requires a PC to do so, which is quite annoying.

Like the others, the packaging includes power and USB cables, and ink cartridges.



The X1150 gave mixed results in our tests. While the text printout took a regular 18 seconds, the photo printout shocked us with a whopping 1521 seconds, or 25 minutes—which clearly shows that it is not meant to be a photo printer. Image quality was average—some of the colours seemed a little washed out, but contrast highlighting was good. However, the dithering was clearly visible. The scanning and copying speed tests were the saving grace for the X1150. It took 15 seconds to scan the the document—the second best time we logged. Copying speeds were acceptable, but the quality was affected by the lack lustre printer unit.

The cost-per-page is Rs 5.33 for black and white prints, and a surprisingly low Rs 4.13 for colour. The X1150 is priced at Rs 5,199, competing directly with the HP PSC 1210. The X1150 would make a good buy, if you want a MFD that can print text fast and scan things quickly at a decent quality. If you want it primarily for photo print look-out for something else.

Lexmark X1150

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 5,199
Pros: Cheap
Cons: Extremely slow photo printing

Advantages and disadvantages of Multi-function Devices

Here are some of the advantages and disadvantages of a Multi-function Device:

Advantages

- ✓ Since an MFD integrates multiple functionality into one device, you can scan, print, and copy on the same device, and if it supports faxing, you can fax as well.
- ✓ These devices usually have hotkeys and specially developed software, which makes them user-friendly—a novice can operate one without much trouble.
- ✓ Since all the functional units are combined into a single machine, you require only one USB port on your PC to connect to all devices, freeing up other ports and reducing wire clutter.
- ✓ In terms of consumables, all that is required are ink cartridges for printing, faxing and so on—this means lower running cost compared to individual peripherals, where one has to buy consumables for each machine.
- ✓ Many high-end MFDs allow you to place the device on the network without the need for attaching a PC. Users can print documents from their PC to the device.

Disadvantages

- ✗ All the components on an MFD cannot be used simultaneously, so if two people need to use two different functions, they'll have to go about it taking turns.
- ✗ If the printer or the scanner unit malfunctions, you won't be able to use the copier and the fax functions.
- ✗ Professionals may well turn a blind eye to these devices as they don't supply the kind of print and scan quality they need.
- ✗ These devices are generally fragile, and proper handling becomes an issue.